TRAINERS AND WHEELS · 12 MIN READ

Indoor trainers: the range, the right pick, setup and use

An indoor trainer lets a customer ride their own bike at home. In Pune that means riding through the monsoon, before sunrise, or after work. We are an authorised Wahoo dealer and we also list Elite, Garmin Tacx, Magene and JetBlack, so we can fit almost any budget.

1. The types

TYPE	HOW IT WORKS	GOOD AND BAD	IN OUR RANGE
Wheel-on	The bike's rear wheel stays on. The tyre presses against a roller.	Cheapest and quick to mount. Louder, wears the tyre, less accurate.	Elite Qubo Fluid, Garmin Tacx Boost, Elite Tuo
Direct drive	The rear wheel comes off. The chain runs on a cassette fixed to the trainer.	Quiet, accurate, realistic feel, no tyre wear. Costs more and needs the right cassette.	Wahoo KICKR CORE 2, KICKR v6 and KICKR MOVE, Elite Rivo, Avanti and Justo 2, Garmin Tacx FLUX and NEO 2T, Magene T500, JetBlack Victory
Rollers	The whole bike sits on rolling drums. The rider balances.	Builds smooth pedalling and balance. Takes practice.	Garmin Tacx Antares. The Wahoo KICKR ROLLR is a smart version that holds the front wheel.
Smart bike	A complete indoor bike. No outdoor bike needed.	Always ready, adjustable for several riders. Highest price.	Wahoo KICKR BIKE, Zwift Ride with KICKR CORE 2

2. Smart or not smart

A **smart trainer** connects to a phone, tablet or computer by Bluetooth or ANT+. It sends the rider's power to the app, and the app controls the resistance. When the road in the app goes uphill, pedalling gets harder. A basic trainer does neither. The rider changes resistance by hand or by shifting gears.

The Elite Qubo Fluid and Garmin Tacx Boost are basic trainers. The Elite Tuo is a smart wheel-on trainer. Every direct drive trainer we list is smart.

Smart trainers work in two modes:

- **ERG mode**: the workout sets a power target, for example 180 watts, and the trainer holds the rider there whatever the cadence. The rider stays in one gear and just pedals.
- **Simulation mode**: resistance follows the gradient of the virtual road. The rider shifts gears exactly as outdoors.

3. What separates a ₹60,000 trainer from a ₹1,60,000 one

- **Power accuracy**: mid-range trainers such as the KICKR CORE 2 measure within about 2%. Top trainers such as the KICKR v6 and Elite Justo 2 measure within about 1%.
- **Maximum resistance and gradient**: top models resist harder sprints and simulate steeper climbs.

- **Feel and noise**: heavier flywheels and better drives feel more like the road.
- **Extras**: the KICKR MOVE slides forward and back as the rider pedals, which is more comfortable on long rides. The Tacx NEO 2T needs no calibration and can run without mains power.

For most customers a mid-range direct drive trainer is the right answer. The top tier is for racers and riders who train by exact power numbers.

4. Our range by budget

BUDGET	TRAINERS	LISTED FROM
Entry, basic	Elite Qubo Fluid, Garmin Tacx Boost, Tacx Antares rollers	₹16,990
Entry, smart	Magene T110, Elite Tuo	₹31,900
Mid, direct drive	JetBlack Victory, Elite Rivo, Wahoo KICKR CORE 2, Elite Avanti, Garmin Tacx FLUX S	₹59,200
Top, direct drive	Elite Justo 2, Wahoo KICKR v6, Garmin Tacx NEO 2T, Wahoo KICKR MOVE	₹1,24,990
Smart bikes	Zwift Ride with KICKR CORE 2, Wahoo KICKR BIKE	₹1,93,000

Prices are our website listings in November 2026. They change, so check the site before you quote.

5. Zwift Cog and Click

Several trainers come in a version "with Zwift Cog and Click", including the KICKR CORE 2, Elite Avanti and JetBlack Victory. Instead of a cassette, the trainer has a single cog. The rider shifts with two small buttons on the handlebar, and the gears are virtual. The big advantage is that one trainer fits bikes from 8 to 12 speed with no cassette to match, so a family with different bikes can share it. Virtual shifting works in Zwift. A customer who uses other apps should take the normal version and a cassette.

6. Selling the right trainer: five questions

- **Which bike will go on it?** You need the number of gears, the brand of the drivetrain, and the rear axle type.
- **What is the goal?** General fitness, structured training, or racing on Zwift.
- **Where will it live?** In a flat with neighbours below, recommend direct drive because it is much quieter.
- **Which screen will you use?** Phone, tablet, laptop or Apple TV. Apps such as Zwift need their own paid subscription, so say so.
- **What is the budget, including the extras?**

7. The three compatibility checks

CHECK	WHAT TO KNOW
Cassette	Many direct drive trainers are sold without a cassette. The customer needs one with the same number of gears as their bike. Sell it with the trainer, or sell the Zwift Cog version.

Freehub body	Trainers come with a Shimano HG freehub, which takes Shimano road cassettes and many SRAM ones. A SRAM 12-speed AXS road bike uses an XDR cassette and needs an XDR freehub body for the trainer. We stock them for Elite, Magene and Tacx.
Axle	Quick release or thru-axle. Most trainers include adapters for both. Check the box before the customer leaves.

For a wheel-on trainer, also recommend a trainer tyre. A normal road tyre wears fast and slips on the roller.

8. Setting it up

- Put a mat on a firm, level floor, near a power socket.
- Fit the cassette and the correct axle adapters to the trainer.
- Shift the bike to the smallest cog, remove the rear wheel, and lower the chain onto the trainer's cassette. Tighten the axle.
- Plug the trainer in. Open the maker's app, such as the Wahoo app, pair the trainer and update its firmware.
- Run a calibration, also called a spindown, if the app asks for one.
- Open the training app and pair the trainer there as the power source and as the controllable trainer.

If the gears skip on the trainer but not on the road, the rear derailleur needs a small adjustment, because the trainer's cassette sits in a slightly different position from the wheel's.

9. Using it well

- **Use a fan.** Indoors there is no wind. Without a fan the rider overheats within minutes.
- **Protect the bike from sweat.** Sweat corrodes the handlebar, stem and headset. A towel or sweat guard over the top tube and a wipe-down after each ride prevent it.
- **Connection drops?** A trainer usually accepts one Bluetooth connection at a time. Close other apps that are connected to it.
- **In ERG mode**, stay in one gear and keep the cadence steady.
- Wipe the trainer down and keep its firmware updated.

10. What to sell with every trainer

Floor mat, fan (the Wahoo KICKR Headwind changes speed with the rider's effort), sweat guard, a cassette or XDR freehub if needed, and a trainer table or tablet stand. Offer them before the bill is made. A customer who goes home without a cassette cannot ride that night.

Remember these

- Wheel-on is cheap and loud. Direct drive is quiet and accurate. Rollers train balance. Smart bikes need no outdoor bike.
- Smart means the app reads power and controls resistance. ERG holds a power target, simulation follows the gradient.
- Check three things: cassette, freehub body, axle.
- Zwift Cog and Click: one cog, virtual gears, fits 8 to 12 speed bikes, works in Zwift.
- Always sell the mat, the fan and sweat protection with the trainer.